

What Is Transcreation?

When the goal is persuasion, a literal translation is not enough.

A working definition

Transcreation is the re-creation of a message so that it produces the same effect in another language and culture. The translator does not move the words; they rebuild the intent — the emotion, the rhythm, the persuasion and the memorability — using whatever wording works best in the target market.

Translation vs. transcreation

	Translation	Transcreation
Unit of work	Meaning	Effect and intent
Fidelity to	The source text	The source goal
Typical use	Documents, reports	Ads, slogans, brand, campaigns
Output	One faithful version	Options, with rationale

When you need it

Use transcreation when the words are doing persuasive work: advertising lines, slogans, taglines, product launches, brand voice and social campaigns. In these cases a literal translation often sounds flat, accidentally comic, or simply wrong.

The process

- Understand the brand, audience, intent and tone of the original.
- Identify what must be preserved (promise, feeling) and what may change (words, images).
- Produce several options, each natural in the target language.
- Explain each choice so the client can decide with confidence.

One line, re-created for six markets

Source (EN): “Taste the freedom.” A fictional demonstration line.

Market	Transcreated line	Why it works
Español	Saborea tu libertad.	Possessive “tu” makes it personal and warm.
Français	Libre comme jamais.	Idiomatic; a literal version would sound flat.
Deutsch	Freiheit, die man schmeckt.	Keeps the sensory promise in

		natural word order.
Português	Prove a liberdade.	Short and punchy, ready for Brazilian ads.
Italiano	Assapora la libertà.	“Assaporare” adds slow, pleasurable tasting.

VERSIÓN EN ESPAÑOL

Qué es la transcreación

La transcreación recrea un mensaje para que produzca el mismo efecto en otro idioma y otra cultura. No se trasladan las palabras: se reconstruye la intención — la emoción, el ritmo y la fuerza persuasiva — con la formulación que mejor funcione en el mercado destino.

Cuándo se necesita

Cuando las palabras persuaden: anuncios, eslóganes, lemas, lanzamientos, voz de marca y campañas. En esos casos, la traducción literal suele sonar plana, involuntariamente cómica o sencillamente equivocada. La transcreación entrega varias opciones, cada una natural en su idioma, con una explicación del porqué.

Language Note published by Scriptorium. The campaign line and its versions are fictional demonstration samples.

Scriptorium · Languages · Texts · Documentation · [scriptorium-language-studio](#) · josuepug@gmail.com